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LETTER DATED 16 FEBRUARY 1971 FROM THE PERMANENT REPRESENTATIVE
OF THE KHMER REPUBLIC TO THE UNITED NATIONS ADDRESSED TO THE
PRESIDENT OF THE SECURITY COUNCIL

On instructions from my Government and further to my Letter No. 464 of 9 February 1971, I have the honour to bring the following to your attention for the information of the members of the Security Council:

On 12 January 1971, a clash took place between Khmer and Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense elements at Boeuer Sâr Krom, 32 km south-east of Phnom Penh on the east bank of the Mekong in Kampong Thom, resulting in a number of enemy dead and wounded who were carried away by their side.

The same day, the Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense harassed a Khmer position at Prek Yoon opposite Boeuer Sâr Krom, wounding 5 persons.

During the night of 18-19 January 1971, about midnight, Khmer troops engaged in clearing National Highway 1 between Prey Veng and Prek Long were harassed by Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense 10 km south-east of Prey Veng near the villages of Prey Ang Kamb and Chou. After return fire from Khmer forces with air support, the enemy was dispersed shortly thereafter.

On 19 January 1971, at approximately 9 a.m., a violent clash took place between Khmer elements engaged in mopping-up operations and some 1,000 Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense about 10 km north-east of Kep in Kampong Thom. Fighting was still continuing at approximately 5 p.m.

The same day, at about 4 a.m., Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense harassed a Khmer position at Sâr Khlong in Kampong Speu for some 30 minutes, using automatic weapons, mortars and 82 mm recoilless weapons.

The same day, at approximately 7 p.m., Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense fired five 82 mm mortar shells at a Khmer position at Kompong Bala in Kompong Bala.

The same day, a violent clash took place some 12 km south-west of the Pich Nil pass on National Highway 4. Our forces lost 4 killed and 10 wounded while the Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense lost 33 dead on the battlefield and several dead and wounded carried away, with 2 men, 2 B40 rocket launchers, 6 AK and a considerable quantity of ammunition captured.

The same day, a violent clash took place at Phum Chhonn Teal Chrum, 7 km south-east of Tram Khmar, in Takeo, resulting in 3 wounded on the Khmer side and 2 dead on the battlefield and 5 wounded carried away on the Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense side.

During the night of 19-20 January 1971, Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense harassed a Khmer position at Jarroer Sâr Len, 32 km south-east of Phnom Penh, in Kendal.

On 20 January 1971, at approximately 7.45 a.m., a clash took place between Khmer elements and some 200 Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense at Phum Kny Bomy, 5 km south of Trea Khmor in Takeo. It lasted two hours and Khmer casualties were 2 dead and 5 wounded, while the enemy suffered 9 dead on the battlefield and several killed and wounded which they carried away.

The same day, a clash took place 14 km north-west of the town of Svay Rieng.

The same day, another clash took place near Vat Chhak, approximately 5 km north-west of the town of Svay Rieng, resulting in 1 dead and 1 wounded on the Khmer side and 5 killed on the battlefield and several dead and wounded carried away on the Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense side.

The same day, at approximately 6 a.m., a clash took place at Ka Miev, some 10 km north-west of Nuong in Battambang, resulting in 2 killed and 3 wounded on the Khmer side while the enemy losses consisted of 6 killed on the battlefield and 1 Chinese sub-machine-gun, three automatic pistols, one B40 rocket launcher and four grenades captured.

The same day, at approximately 7.25 a.m., another clash took place 4 kilometres north-east of the Pich Nil pass in Kompung Seila. It lasted some 20 minutes, after which the enemy withdrew in disorder.

The same day, at approximately 7 a.m., Khmer forces engaged in clearing National Highway 4 clashed violently with Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense occupying fortified bunkers on either side of the road at the entry to the Pich Nil pass.

Hand-to-hand fighting broke out at approximately 6 p.m. Casualties were tentatively estimated at 7 killed and 56 wounded on the Khmer side and 31 killed on the battlefield, 4 taken prisoner and some weapons captured on the enemy side.

The same day, at approximately 7.30 a.m., a clash lasting some two hours took place 7 kilometres south-west of Tama Khmar in Kampong Speu, resulting in 2 dead on the Khmer side and 9 killed on the battlefield and several killed and wounded carried away on the Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense side.

The same day, at approximately 7.30 p.m., Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense again harassed Srd Khlong in Kampong Speu.

On 21 January 1971 at approximately 2.30 p.m., Khmer troops successfully occupied the chalet at Pich Hill after a vigorous mopping-up operation to eliminate all pockets of enemy resistance. The result of the operation was 2 killed on the Khmer side whereas the enemy lost 10 killed on the battlefield and 2 Chinese automatic pistols and a large quantity of ammunition were captured.

During the night of 21-22 January 1971, Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense attacked a Khmer defence position at Socerkong and another at Kambeul, situated 32 kilometres north-east and fifteen kilometres north-west of Pnom Penh respectively.

The same night, the Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense, using heavy weapons, harassed the town of Kampong Cham and the locality of Poul Pot in Kampong Cham.

The same night, the Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense attacked a Khmer position at Kampong Chhik, 10 kilometres north of the town of Svay Rieng.

On 22 January 1971, at approximately 5.45 a.m., Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense were ambushed by friendly forces some 21 kilometres east of Kampong Gella. The enemy withdrew, leaving 31 dead on the battlefield.

The same day, at approximately 12 a.m., Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense harassed a Khmer position 2 kilometres south-west of Stang Chhal. Following counter-attack by the Khmer forces, 4 of whom were wounded, the enemy withdrew leaving on the battlefield 1 M48 36, 1 M48 49 automatic pistol and 2 Chinese automatic pistols with 4 full magazines.

The same day, Khmer elements engaged in mopping-up operations clashed with Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense at Kampong, some 10 kilometres west of Khmor Pech in Kambeul. The Khmer side suffered 3 killed and 20 wounded while the enemy suffered 10 killed and some 20 wounded.

During the night of 22-23 January 1971, Viet-Cong-North Viet-Enemies attacked a Khmer position at Tak Kbleang and another at Phlao Trei, situated some 22 kilometres south-east of Phnom Penh on the east bank of the Mekong in Kandal.

The same night, at approximately 11 p.m., Viet-Cong-North Viet-Enemies attacked the petrol depot at Prek Phnom, some 12 kilometres north-west of Phnom Penh in Kandal. Heavy return fire by the Khmer defenders forced the enemy to withdraw at approximately 11.30 p.m. leaving on the battlefield 3 ¹²⁰mm, 1 106G rocket launcher and 8 shells, 30 plastic charges and a full Chinese sub-machine-gun magazine and carrying away some 30 killed and wounded.

The same night, the Viet-Cong-North Viet-Enemies harassed the Khmer defence complex at the town of Prey Veng.

On 23 January 1971, a clash occurred between Khmer and Viet-Cong-North Viet-Enemies at Svay Khos, 7 kilometres east of the town of Siem Reap, lasting approximately 30 minutes.

The same day, the enemy briefly harassed a Khmer position 10 kilometres north-west of the town of Kompong Cham.

The same day, at approximately 5.45 a.m., Viet-Cong-North Viet-Enemies attacked a Khmer position at Neung in Kandal, wounding 2 of the Khmer forces.

The same day, the enemy harassed a Khmer position at Neak Ta Samrong, 25 kilometres south-east of Phnom Penh in Kandal.

During the night of 23-24 January 1971, Viet-Cong-North Viet-Enemies intermittently harassed a Khmer position at Trepseng Thnot, some 23 kilometres north-west of Phnom Penh in Kandal from 6.45 p.m. until dawn, without causing any damage.

During the same night, at approximately 7.15 p.m., a Khmer position at Wat Tala, on the northern outskirts of the capital, in Kandal, was also harassed. Heavy return fire by the Khmer forces forced the enemy to withdraw, leaving one dead on the battlefield.

During the same night, at approximately 11 p.m., Viet-Cong-North Viet-Enemies harassed a Khmer position at Kompong Teul, 2 kilometres west of Kompong Koutut, in Kandal.

During the same night, Viet-Cong-North Viet-Enemies harassed a Khmer position at O Saudey, 2 kilometres north-west of the town of Svay Rieng, with

mortar and automatic-weapon fire. Counteraction by the Khmer forces, 2 of whom were wounded, forced the enemy to withdraw, leaving one dead on the battlefield.

During the night of 24-25 January 1971, at approximately 3.15 p.m., Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense harassed a Khmer position at Prek Phanon, wounding one man.

During the same night, they also harassed a Khmer position at Bat Namung and another at Kamhoul, situated respectively 29 kilometres north-west and 15 kilometres north-west of Phnom Penh, in Kamdal.

During the same night, about midnight and about 4 a.m. on 25 January 1971, Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense again harassed the Pochentong air base with mortar and automatic-weapon fire.

On 25 January 1971, from 1.30 a.m. to 4 a.m., the enemy harassed a Khmer position at Phum Ta Kout, 11 kilometres west of Kompong Travok, in Prey Veng. The Khmer forces, 3 of whom were wounded, took vigorous counteraction, forcing the Viet-Cong - North Viet-Namense to withdraw leaving 1 dead and 4 rifles on the battlefield.

I wish to reaffirm the firm and vigorous protest of the Government of the Khmer Republic against the illegal and permanent occupation of Khmer territory, followed by savage attacks perpetrated by the Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense forces against a neutral and peace-loving country to which they have no right and with which they have no ethnic affinity, in flagrant violation of the United Nations Charter, of international law and of the 1954 Geneva Agreements. These criminal attacks reveal for all to see the expansionist aims of the Viet-Cong-North Viet-Namense communist imperialists, and represent a dangerous threat to peace and security not only in the Khmer Republic, but throughout the region of South-East Asia.

The Government of the Khmer Republic holds the Government of the Democratic Republic of Viet-Nam and the so-called Provisional Revolutionary Government of South Viet-Nam entirely responsible for all the extremely grave consequences resulting from this situation and reserves the right to take any necessary action to defend the independence, neutrality, sovereignty and territorial integrity of the country.

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I should be grateful if you would have the text of this communication circulated as a Security Council document.

(Signed) KHUM ENT
Permanent Representative
of the Khmer Republic
